Comparing the cash-to-GDP ratio of various countries versus their per capita income, the survey noted that India had a very high amount of cash in circulation compared to other countries in the same income bracket, even allowing for the estimated level of corruption in the system. This leads to one of two possible conclusions: either India is more corrupt than estimated, or cash is being used for legitimate purposes.

The Survey then proposed the hypothesis that notes actually being used for transactions would be more 'soiled' whereas notes that were black money would be just 'stored' and hence less soiled. To estimate how many high-value notes are actually used in transactions, it compared the rate to 'soiled American dollar notes' and concluded: 'Using relative soil rates for the US $50 and $20 notes and applying them to comparable Indian high denomination notes, yields an estimate of the amount not used for transactions, and hence potentially black, of *about ₹3 lakh crore*. This is substantial, as it represents about two per cent of GDP.'

Though the Survey itself admits this is an imperfect estimation, it comes closest to an official estimation of India's black money.

Estimates by various economists of India's black economy have ranged between 25 per cent to 62 per cent of our GDP. Prof. Arun Kumar, eminent author and expert on India's black economy, provided the following estimate:[5]

India's GDP in 2016–17	₹150 lakh crore
India's Black Economy/Income 2016–17	62 per cent of GDP
India's Black Income in 2016–17	₹93 lakh crore/ year
India's Black Wealth in 2016–17	3 x Black Income = approx. ₹300 lakh crore
India's Black Money in 2016–17	One per cent of Black Wealth = approx. ₹3 lakh crore

Given that the two estimates, one in the Economic Survey and the other by Prof. Arun Kumar, are identical, even though they have been